Lists in HTML Cheatsheet

Learn how to put things in neat bulleted and numbered lists on your web page!

💡 The Big Idea

- A list groups related items together on a web page.
- HTML has three kinds of lists: unordered, ordered and description.
- Every list is made of a list container and items inside it.
- Lists make pages easier to read, like a shopping list or a recipe.

🔵 Unordered Lists (Bullets)

- Use <ul> for a list where order does not matter.
- Each item goes inside <li> and .
- The browser adds bullet dots for you.
- Example uses: snacks, favourite games, school bag items.

🔢 Ordered Lists (Numbers)

- Use <ol> for a list where order matters.
- Each item still uses <li>.
- The browser numbers the items 1, 2, 3 automatically.
- Example uses: recipe steps, race results, how to brush teeth.
- The type attribute changes the style: type="A" gives A, B, C and type="i" gives i, ii, iii.
- The start attribute picks the first number, like start="5".

📖 Description Lists

- Use <dl> to make a list of terms and their meanings.
- <dt> holds the term (the name).
- <dd> holds the description (the meaning).
- It works like a mini dictionary or glossary.

🪆 Nested Lists (List Inside a List)

- You can put a new <ul> or <ol> inside an <li>.
- This makes sub-items, like fruits under a Food heading.
- The inner list must be inside the <li>, before its closing .
- Browsers show inner bullets with a different shape and indent them.

🛠️ Step-by-Step: Make Your First List

- Step 1: Decide if order matters. Yes means <ol>, no means <ul>.
- Step 2: Type the opening tag, like <ul>.
- Step 3: Add one item for each thing.
- Step 4: Type the closing tag, like .
- Step 5: Open the page in a browser and check your list.

🌍 Lists in Real Life

- Menus on websites are often made with <ul>.
- Recipes use <ol> for steps and <ul> for ingredients.
- Top 10 charts use <ol>.
- Glossaries and FAQs can use <dl>.

💻 Code Examples

Unordered List — html

```html
<h2>My Snacks</h2>
<ul>
  <li>Popcorn</li>
  <li>Apple</li>
  <li>Sandwich</li>
</ul>
```

▶ Output:

```
My Snacks
• Popcorn
• Apple
• Sandwich
```

This makes a bullet list of snacks. Each snack is one list item.

Ordered List — html

```html
<h2>Brush Your Teeth</h2>
<ol>
  <li>Put paste on the brush</li>
  <li>Brush for two minutes</li>
  <li>Rinse your mouth</li>
</ol>
```

▶ Output:

```
Brush Your Teeth
1. Put paste on the brush
2. Brush for two minutes
3. Rinse your mouth
```

This makes a numbered list of steps. The browser adds the numbers.

Description List — html

```html
<dl>
  <dt>ul</dt>
  <dd>Makes a bullet list</dd>
  <dt>ol</dt>
  <dd>Makes a numbered list</dd>
</dl>
```

▶ Output:

```
ul
    Makes a bullet list
ol
    Makes a numbered list
```

This lists terms with their meanings. <dt> is the term and <dd> is the meaning.

Nested List html

```
<ul>
  <li>Fruits
    <ul>
      <li>Apple</li>
      <li>Banana</li>
    </ul>
  </li>
  <li>Vegetables</li>
</ul>
```

▶ Output:

- Fruits
  - Apple
  - Banana
- Vegetables

The inner list sits inside an <li>. It shows sub-items under Fruits.

📚 Key Terms

List	A group of related items shown together.
** **	Unordered list. Items get bullet points.
** **	Ordered list. Items get numbers or letters.
** **	List item. One entry inside a or .
<dl>	Description list. Holds terms and their descriptions.
<dt>	Description term. The name being described.
<dd>	Description details. The meaning of the term.
Nested list	A list placed inside a list item of another list.
type attribute	Changes the numbering style of an , such as A, a, I, i or 1.
start attribute	Sets the number an begins counting from.

🧮 Formulas & Rules

```
Bullet list: <ul><li>item</li></ul>
```

```
Numbered list: <ol><li>item</li></ol>
```

```
Description list: <dl><dt>term</dt><dd>meaning</dd></dl>
```

```
Nested list: <li>item<ul><li>sub-item</li></ul></li>
```

```
Ordered list style: <ol type="A"> or <ol start="5">
```

🖍️ Worked Examples

Q: Make a bullet list of 3 fruits: apple, banana, mango.
A: Step 1: Order does not matter, so use <ul>. Step 2: Add an <li> for each fruit. Step 3: Close with . The browser shows three bullet points.

Q: Make a numbered list of steps to make tea: boil water, add tea, pour in cup.
A: Step 1: Order matters, so use <ol>. Step 2: Write one <li> per step in the right order. Step 3: Close with . The browser shows 1, 2, 3.

Q: How do you show Fruits with Apple and Banana inside it?
A: Step 1: Make a <ul> with an <li> that says Fruits. Step 2: Before closing that , add a new <ul> with two <li> items. Step 3: Close both lists properly.

🚫 Common Mistakes

- Putting text straight inside <ul> or <ol> without <li> around it.
- Forgetting to close tags like or .
- Using <ul> when the steps must be in order (use <ol> instead).
- Placing a nested list outside the <li> instead of inside it.
- Typing the numbers yourself like 1. Milk. The <ol> adds numbers for you.

👫 Parent Corner

- Ask your child to write the weekly grocery list as an HTML list, using <ul>.
- Have them turn a favourite recipe into an <ol> for the steps and a <ul> for the ingredients.
- Play 'bullets or numbers?': name an activity and let them say which list type fits.
- Let them make a <dl> of 4 family words and their meanings, like a mini dictionary.
- Encourage them to change the <ol> type to A, B, C and see what happens.

🎯 Quick Check (tap to reveal)

1. 1. Which tag makes a bulleted list?
   ✅
2. 2. Which tag makes a numbered list?
   ✅
3. 3. Which tag is used for each item in a <ul> or ?
   ✅
4. 4. In a description list, which tag holds the meaning?
   ✅ <dd>
5. 5. Where must a nested list be placed?
   ✅ Inside an <li> of the outer list.